Time Synchronisation Evidence

Ref: 5.2
Product: iConnect Plus
Organisation: Cache Digitech
Classification: Internal — Confidential
Version: 2.0
Date: 2026-11-03
Deployment model: On-premises (Cache Digitech premises) · VPN for remote access
Audience: IT infrastructure, auditors, security assessors

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1. Purpose

Demonstrate that systems hosting iConnect Plus maintain **accurate, synchronised time** traceable to **NIC/NPL** or an **internal NTP** hierarchy traceable to them — supporting log correlation, certificate validity, MFA TOTP, and CERT-In incident timelines.

2. Scope

System	Role
Docker application host(s)	Runs all ERP containers
Backup / log server (if separate)	Timestamp on archives
VPN appliance	Session correlation
Admin workstations (ops)	SSH access evidence

3. Policy

Requirement	Standard
Protocol	NTP (chrony or systemd-timesyncd)
Stratum	Traceable to NIC/NPL or approved internal source
Timezone	UTC on servers; IST for human reports as needed
Max drift	**Template / Pending sign-off** (e.g. ≤ 500 ms to source)

4. Configuration baseline (template)

Host	NTP source	Service	Drift check
SRV-ERP-01	**Template / Pending sign-off** (e.g. `time.nic.in` or internal)	chrony	**Pending**
SRV-ERP-02 (DR)	Same hierarchy	chrony	**Pending**
VPN-01	Vendor default / IT policy	—	**Pending**

5. Evidence collection procedure

Run on each application host (example for chrony):

```
timedatectl status
chronyc tracking
chronyc sources -v
```

Evidence item	Attach to audit pack
`timedatectl` output	Screenshot or text export
`chronyc tracking`	Shows reference ID and offset
NTP server allow-list	IT network diagram excerpt
Last quarterly review ticket	**Template / Pending sign-off**

Collected evidence bundle: Template / Pending sign-off

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6. Container time

Docker containers inherit host clock. Policy: **do not** run independent NTP inside app containers unless host sync is broken.

Check	Command
Container vs host	`docker exec erp-api date -u` vs `date -u`

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7. Application impact

Feature	Sensitivity to clock skew
JWT expiry	High — skew > few minutes causes auth failures
TOTP MFA	High — ±30s window typical
Audit `created_at`	Medium — uses UTC from DB/app
TLS certificates	High — notBefore/notAfter

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8. Remediation

Condition	Action
Skew detected	Fix NTP on host; restart containers if needed
NTP unreachable	Failover to secondary NIC/NPL or internal stratum-2
Persistent drift	Replace hardware clock / hypervisor sync review

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9. Related documents

Ref	Document
5.3	Hardening Configuration Baseline
5.1	Logging & Monitoring Specification
5.4	Incident Response Plan

10. Change log

Date	Change	By
2026-11-03	v2.0 NTP evidence template	Platform

IT attestation: Template / Pending sign-off